

SURVEY FINDINGS

What club officials told us.

Findings from the RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026: how grassroots football clubs organise volunteers, the time it takes, and the problems they run into.

122

CLUB OFFICIALS SURVEYED

67+

GRASSROOTS FOOTBALL CLUBS

5

STATES

Research by RosterDay

Fieldwork: 26 May to 30 September 2026 · n=122

Five patterns across the report

- 01 Not enough volunteers is the main problem.
- 02 A small core carries the load.
- 03 Burnout is higher where coordination is spread across more channels.
- 04 How duties are assigned moves the work, but doesn't reduce it.
- 05 Most coordination admin goes unmeasured.

98%

NAMED FINDING ENOUGH VOLUNTEERS OR THE SAME PEOPLE ALWAYS HELPING AS A TOP CHALLENGE

2.6

TOOLS AND CHANNELS USED PER CLUB, ON AVERAGE

40-60hrs

TYPICAL COORDINATION ADMIN PER CLUB, PER SEASON

About this research

COLLECTION

Online survey shared through football Facebook groups, emails to clubs and associations, and an A-League club's grassroots network.

WHO ANSWERED

86% hold a committee or administrative role; 45% are office bearers.

FIELDWORK

26 May to 30 September 2026.
No incentive. No product named.

READING THE DATA

Margin of error about ± 9 points. A strong indication, not a precise national measure.

122

COMPLETED RESPONSES

67+

DISTINCT CLUBS IDENTIFIED, ACROSS FIVE STATES

76%

ASKED TO RECEIVE THE FINDINGS

WHO WE SURVEYED · Q1



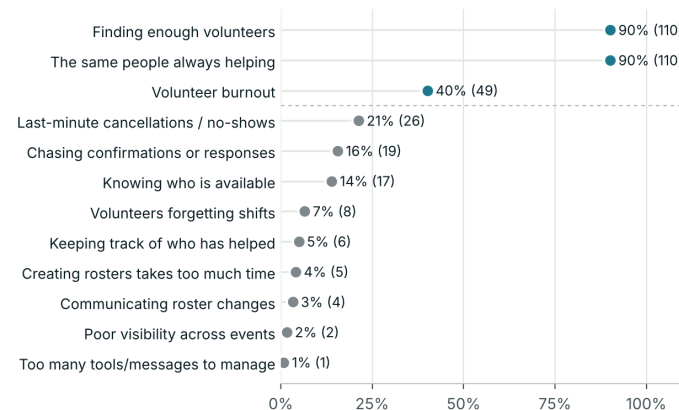
■ Regularly organise volunteers ■ Occasionally help ■ Hold a club role, don't coordinate volunteers

The main problem is a shortage of people

Finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping were each named by 90%. 98% named at least one of the two. Admin problems, such as creating rosters (4%), were rarely chosen.

Two challenges dominate: finding enough volunteers and the same people always helping

Q9 - Respondents were asked to select their top three. n = 122.



Percentages sum to more than 100%. 9 respondents selected more than three options.
Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q9, n=122

Q9 · n=122 · respondents picked their top three
RosterDay · Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

Small clubs spend about 8× more coordination time per volunteer than the largest clubs

Estimated weekly coordination minutes per active volunteer, by club size (clubs that gave an estimate, n=107)



Derived using band midpoints for both hours and volunteer count (Fewer than 10 = 7; 100+ = 125 as a conservative value). Indicative only. 51-100 has n = 6.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q4 and Q10 (derived), n=107

A small core carries the load, and it wears them down

Clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers cover nearly the same range of activities as clubs five times their size. Per volunteer, they spend about 19 minutes a week on coordination, against about 2 minutes in clubs with more than 100.

40%

NAMED VOLUNTEER BURNOUT AS A TOP-THREE CHALLENGE

54%

IN CLUBS WITH FEWER THAN 10 VOLUNTEERS

Coordination runs on chat apps and spreadsheets

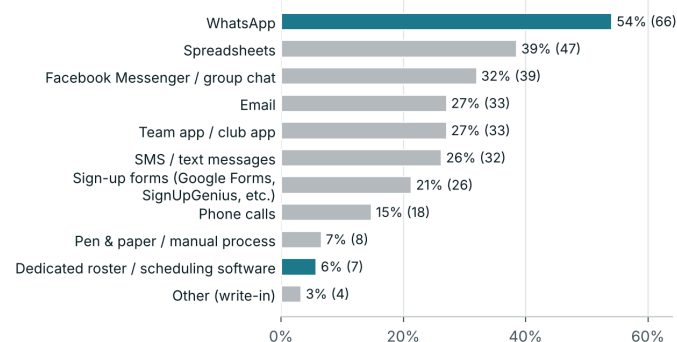
WhatsApp is used by 54% of clubs and spreadsheets by 39%. Only 6% use dedicated rostering software, and most of those still run it alongside other tools.

2.6 Average tools and channels per club

75% Use two or more

WhatsApp is used by 54% of clubs; dedicated rostering software by 6%

Share of clubs using each tool to organise volunteers and duty rosters (n=122, select all that apply)



Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q7, n=122

Q7 · n=122 · select all that apply

RosterDay · Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

More channels go with more burnout

51% of clubs using three or more channels named burnout, against 31% using one or two. The gap held in three of four size bands.

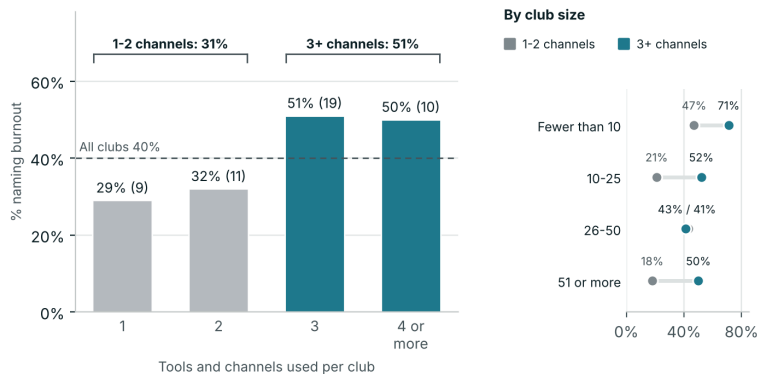
UNSURE OF HOURS 19% (3+ channels) vs 6% (1-2 channels)

TOO MANY TOOLS Named by 1 respondent

CAVEAT Association, not causation.

Half of clubs juggling three or more channels report burnout, against under a third of the rest

Share of clubs naming volunteer burnout as a top-three challenge, by number of tools and channels used (n=122)



Q7 × Q9 · n=122

RosterDay · Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

Coordination takes real time, and much of it goes unmeasured

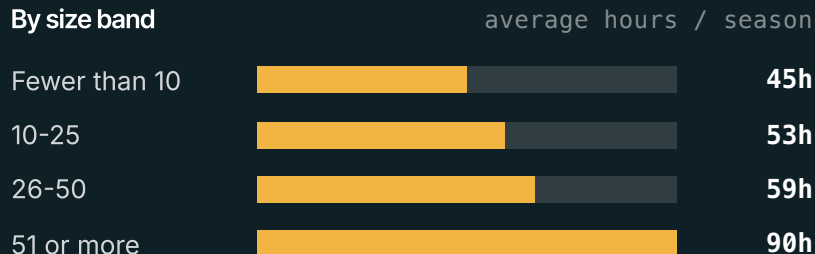
Most clubs spend 1-3 hours a week organising volunteers. Together, respondents who gave an estimate account for about 6,300 hours a season. 12% couldn't estimate their time at all.

METHOD Band midpoints × 20-week season; "Unsure" excluded.

BASE n=107 respondents who gave an estimate

40-60h

COORDINATION HOURS PER CLUB, PER SEASON,
BEFORE ANYONE DOES A DUTY

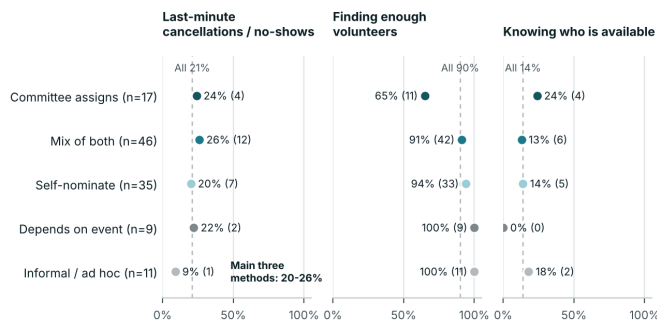


Median is 40h in every band.

No assignment method prevents no-shows

No assignment method stops no-shows. Committee assignment trades a supply problem for an admin one

Share of clubs naming each challenge, by how duties are usually assigned (n=122)



Small bases: Committee assigns n=17, Depends n=9, Ad hoc n=11. Treat differences as indicative. 'Other' (n=4) not shown; see Table 22.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q8 by Q9, n=122

No-shows sit at 20-26% under every main method. Each method moves the work somewhere else.

COMMITTEE ASSIGNS · n=17

Finding volunteers 65% · Knowing who is available 24%

MIX OF BOTH · n=46

Burnout 50% · No-shows 26%

SELF-NOMINATE · n=35

Finding volunteers 94% · No-shows 20%

Mid-sized clubs are in transition

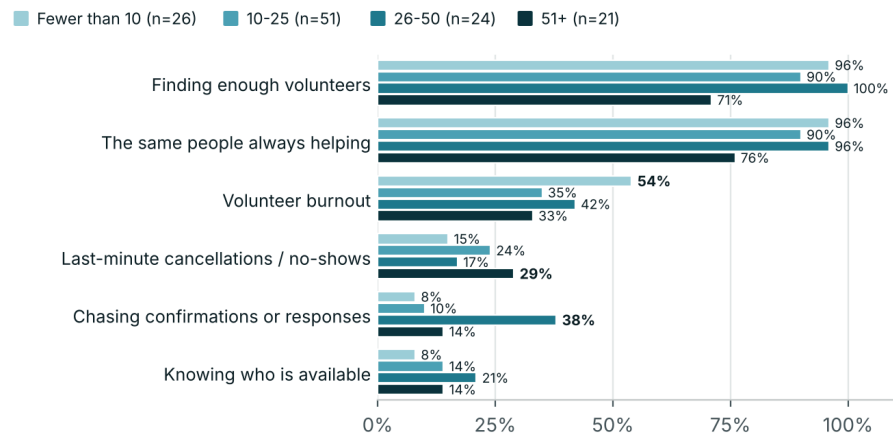
Clubs with 26-50 volunteers have outgrown informal coordination but haven't moved to a structured system. They average 3.3 channels, and 38% name chasing confirmations.

25% Unsure of their weekly hours, against 12% overall

50% Mix assigning and self-selection

Small clubs burn out; mid-sized clubs chase confirmations

Q9 by Q4 (active volunteers per season). Respondents selected their top three.



51-100 and 100+ combined due to small base (n = 7 and n = 14). Highlighted values are called out in the text.

Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q9 by Q4, n=122

Q4 × Q7 · Q8 · Q9 · Q10 · 26-50 band n=24

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What clubs would change about volunteer coordination

Themes in answers to 'If you could improve one thing about volunteer coordination at your club, what would it be?'

■ People supply ■ Coordination mechanics



Q11, open text, coded. n = 110 substantive answers. Some answers coded to two themes.
Source: RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026, Q11, n=110

Asked about coordination, most answered about people

60% of answers were about getting people to help (66 of 110). 45% (49) were about the mechanics.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS



People actually volunteering instead of adopting the 'I've paid my fees I don't need to do anything' approach.

REGISTRAR / ADMINISTRATOR • CULTURE



One truth - what volunteers are available, where do we need them.

COMMITTEE MEMBER • 51 OR MORE VOLUNTEERS

Quotes are anonymised. Role and size band only, never club names.

Levies rarely solve the problem on their own



Most people are happy to pay it and not volunteer.

Follow-up respondent

Volunteer levy question

WHY THIS QUOTE

Only 4 of 41 follow-up respondents run a levy for all families, and 4 more tried one and stopped. The schemes with some success reward a clearly defined role.

6 of 10

**SAID A LEVY DIDN'T INCREASE
VOLUNTEERING**

FOR CLUB COMMITTEES

Six actions for club committees

01 Treat it as a people problem first

98% named a supply challenge

02 Make contribution visible

Only 5% track who has helped

03 Protect the core few

54% burnout in clubs with fewer than 10 volunteers

04 Cut the number of channels

Burnout 51% vs 31%

05 Choose an assignment method on purpose

No-shows 20-26% under every main method

06 Measure the workload

12% couldn't estimate their hours

Source: Key Takeaways, RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

RosterDay · Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

FOR ASSOCIATIONS AND GOVERNING BODIES

Six actions above club level

01 Treat supply as a sport-wide issue

About 90% named it in nearly every cut

02 Help clubs expect contribution

9 asked for volunteering to be compulsory

03 Focus support on small clubs

54% burnout; 77% open to practical help

04 Help mid-sized clubs move to a structured system

3.3 channels; 38% chase confirmations

05 Recognise coordination as volunteer work

About 6,300 hours a season

06 Involve clubs in designing support

76% want the findings; 70% open to pilots

Source: Key Takeaways, RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

RosterDay · Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026

A NOTE FROM ROSTERDAY

Thank you to the 122 club officials who took part.

This deck summarises the RosterDay Football Volunteer Coordination Survey 2026. Read the full report at rosterday.com.au/results for the data tables, method, club-size breakdowns and levy follow-up. Thank you also to the 41 who answered the follow-up.

QUESTIONS

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FULL REPORT

RosterDay Football Volunteer
Coordination Survey 2026
64 pages · rosterday.com.au/results